

Day 3 — Product Design & UX

Principles for TPMs · Facilitator Guide

Companion to `labs/day-03-design-ux.md` . Facilitator-only — do not hand to participants. Cues, answer keys, timings, reflections.

Activity 1 — Heuristic Hunt

Cues:

- If two quads pick the same violation, ask the second one: "What did you see that the first quad missed?" — sharpens observation.
- If a quad picks "the colors are ugly" — redirect to a heuristic. "Aesthetic" is in the list, but "I don't like the colors" is not the same.

Activity 2 — A11y Floor Audit

Cues:

- Most cohorts under-rate a11y findings on first pass. If a quad reports "all pass," ask them to try the keyboard-only flow themselves.
- Push the quad that finishes early to convert fails into severity scores — that's the bridge to Activity 3.

Activity 3 — Heuristic Audit of Your Quad's Surface

Cues:

- Force the strengths column. Most quads default to a kill list and lose designer trust before they've earned it.
- Watch severity scoring drift. A "5" should be rare; if a quad scores three things at 5, push them to differentiate.

Activity 4 — From Audit to Design Principles

Cues:

- Pin the **3-Principle Cards** alongside the NS Defense Cards. Tomorrow's AI strategy work and Friday's journey map both reference them.
- Refuse "be consistent" or "be user-friendly" — they fail the decision test. The quad must rewrite before locking.

Facilitator reflection prompts (end of day)

- Which quad fell into the "I just don't like it" trap? They need help converting reaction to vocabulary tomorrow.
- Which quad's principles are the sharpest? Pull one as a positive example for Friday.
- Did anyone treat A11y as optional? That's a Week 4 risk to head off now.